Forsyth County News

Your "Hometown Paper" Since 1908

Vol. 88, No. 135 **WEDNESDAY** NOVEMBER 12, 1997

*01 F006130 03/23/98
GO DAWGS!!!
NEWSPAPER GEORGIA
* UNIVERSITY OF GEORGIA

ATHENS GA 30602

Partly cloudy



Chance of rain.
Highs in the 50s.
Lows in the low 30s.

THIS ISSUE

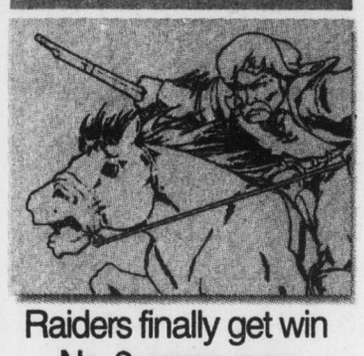
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Opinion



Cartoonists' views on the news.
Page 12A

Sports



Raiders finally get win No. 2; romp over Riverside, 55-24.
Page 1B

LAKE LANIER LEVELS

Date	Level
Nov. 7	1067.45 ft
Nov. 8	1067.44 ft
Nov. 9	1067.43 ft
Nov. 10	1067.45 ft
Normal	1071.00 ft

Schools



Learning opportunities take students back in time; to Wall Street.
Page 5-6A

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COMING FRIDAY

ENTERTAINMENT SECTION

Soap Opera Updates, Critics Corner, Jill Jackson's Hollywood, Country Music and TV listings in Friday.

Missed paper policy:
For a replacement paper, call 8 a.m. to 6 p.m. Wednesday and Friday, and 9 a.m. to 1 p.m. on Sunday – **887-3126**.

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Commissioner responds to Grand Jury

By Sheri Toomey
Staff Writer

Chairman Bill Jenkins started off the Board of Commissioners' Monday meeting with comments regarding the recent Grand Jury presentments.

Jenkins twice said he believed the grand jury had received poor information especially regarding employees morale.

"I am not trying to discredit the grand jury," said Jenkins. "But more than one commissioner found the information to be quite to the contrary."

The grand jury found county employees' morale at an all time low but according to Jenkins it is exactly the opposite.

Employees in more than one department have expressed problems with morale and concern over losing their jobs.

Jenkins also requested future grand juries to cease mentioning a hit list of employees who will be let go in the future since he had not seen any proof of a list.

"I give my personal assurance there is no witch hunt going on by the board," said Jenkins. (The grand jury foreman responds at right.)

In other business conducted after coming out of closed session to discuss personnel matters, the board voted unanimously to offer the finance director position to Richard L. Russell.

See ***COMMISSIONER***, Page 2A

Response from foreman

Quotes from Grand Jury Foreman Carol Cowdry, commenting after Monday night's comments by Commission Chairman Bill Jenkins

– "We still know a hit list exists."

– "We have spoken to over 30 people that work for the county government and found morale at an all time low."

See ***JURY***, Page 2A

Forsyth Central Homecoming honors

Kacy Campbell, the 1997 Forsyth Central High School Homecoming Queen crowned on Nov. 7 is escorted by her father, Len Campbell Jr. Last year's Homecoming queen, Jessica Jordan, crowned Kacy. More photo coverage of the Homecoming in Friday's edition.



Photo/Tom Brooks

Public safety director post still disputed

By Sheri Toomey
Staff Writer

Whether the county should have voted to hire a public safety director was again questioned at Monday's public forum.

Some firefighters spoke in opposition to this move but several residents said the Board of Commissioners were going in the right direction.

Volunteer firefighter Charles Turner commended the board's decision regarding expansion. "I think you're making a positive step," said Turner.

Volunteer firefighter Christopher Bruckner questioned why the board would not discuss the matter when Commissioner John Kieffer raised questions about the action.

See ***POST***, Page 2A

Improper water hookups checked

By Michael Kurtz
Staff Writer

The Etowah Trail Subdivision water hookup at a house permitted in the name of Commissioner John Kieffer isn't the only place in town with improper water hookups.

According to reports to the Sheriff's Office, at least nine other area homes and subdivisions have water hookups but no meters.

One belongs to Commissioner Lamar Suddeth.

A spokesman for the Sheriff's Office said Jasper Grading and Pipeline, Suddeth's grading company, had water lines connected to the county's water system, but no meter.

Suddeth had purchased a meter which was never hooked up, state reports.

The Sheriff's Office spokesperson said the problem was corrected days before investigators received reports about Kieffer's hookup.

An investigation has been opened into the Etowah Trail matter, but so far, that is the only incident.

"I wish we had known about the other connection before they were given time to correct it," said a source at the Sheriff's Office.

Other locations where water is reportedly being taken without a meter include North Glen Drive, Glen Brooke Drive, Shiloh Road, Arbor Chase, Oakmont Bend Drive, Pine Ridge Circle and at the Laurel Springs golf clubhouse.

See ***HOOKUPS***, Page 2A

Father of murdered child out on bond

By Michael Kurtz
Staff Writer

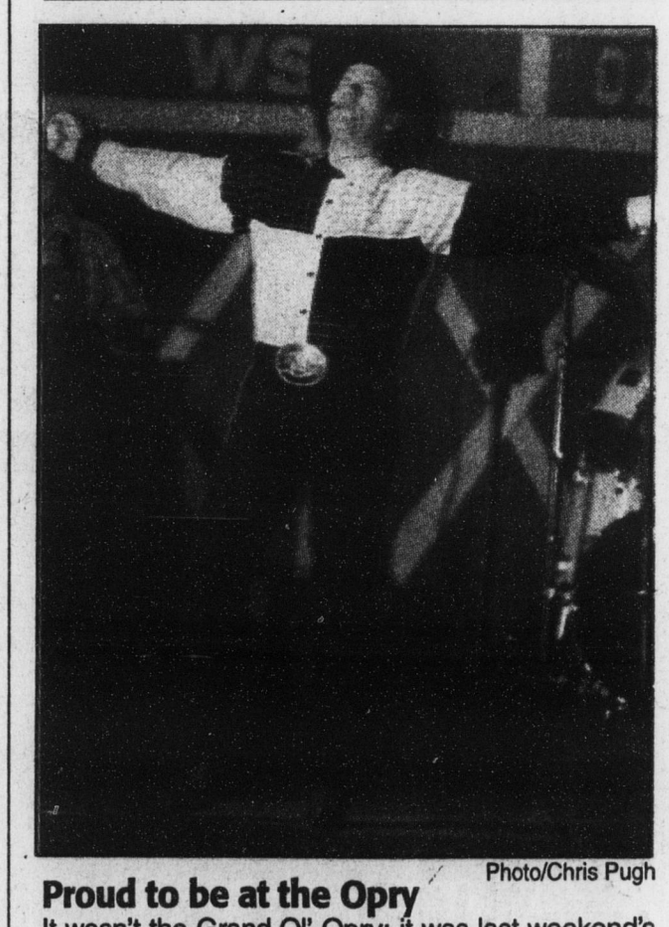
Following a week of negotiations, the father of 11-year-old murder victim Levi Frady was released from the Forsyth County Detention Center Monday.

Superior Court Judge Frank Mills ordered Milton Frady to wear an electronic monitoring system and remain at the Nichols Road home of his parents, Lamar and Sara Frady, unless appearing in court.

Frady turned himself in to the Sheriff's Office Oct. 29. He was wanted for failing to appear in court in 1995 to answer to charges of burglary and contributing to the delinquency of a minor.

Investigators from the Forsyth and Dawson county sheriff's departments and the Georgia Bureau Investigation wanted to question him about the Oct. 22 murder of his son, whose body was found Oct. 23 in a Dawson County forest by three hunters from Gilmer County. Levi disappeared Oct. 22 and family and neighbors searched north Forsyth County for the boy.

See ***BOND***, Page 2A



Photo/Chris Pugh

Proud to be at the Opry

It wasn't the Grand Ol' Opry; it was last weekend's Oak Grove Opry IX and Garth Brooks (Russell Moore) performed. More photos on Page 10A.



Photo/Chris Pugh

Signed ... Lorrie Morgan

Country music singer, songwriter and author Lorrie Morgan was at the Cumming Wal-Mart Superstore on Friday for an autograph party. Cumming Mayor Ford Gravitt was on hand to provide a welcome as were Wal-Mart's Bill Tesney, Tom Fisher, Bruce Gardner, Bill Orbeck and Mae-Ronnie Carpenter. The mayor was among those who lined up to get Morgan's signature on her book, Forever Yours, Faithfully.

Plane crash injures two

By Michael Kurtz
Staff Writer

The Federal Aviation Administration and the National Transportation Safety Board are investigating a Sunday evening plane crash on Bagley Road.

A Cessna 172 single-engine plane went down on Bagley Road around 5:30 p.m. shortly after taking off from Mathis Airport.

According to the Sheriff's Office report, the plain clipped the top of trees near the runway and landed approximately 200 feet northwest of the airport 50 feet into the woods off Bagley Road.

Witnesses told investigators they saw the plain bouncing on the runway prior to take off. It broke into several pieces after the crash.

The pilot, 46-year-old Edward Brainard of New Jersey, and his passenger, 50-year-old Joseph Gorence of Pennsylvania, were taken to Baptist North Hospital.



Photo/Chris Pugh

Identification number barely visible.

They were treated for minor injuries and released.

Sheriff's Office spokesperson Karleen Chalker said the two had flown into town to visit friends and were leaving at the time of the crash.

See ***PLANE***, Page 2A